



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Alexandria Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.accacademy.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Alexandria Classical Christian Academy (ACCA) VA 22302 presents a robust classical Christian orientation across all six rubric categories. Public-facing materials consistently frame ACCA as a Christ-centered, formation-first school that embraces the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; etc.), a Great-Books/Humanities approach to history and literature, Socratic (and occasionally dialectic) pedagogy in upper grades, and a strong faculty-student/parent-partnership culture. Multiple pages articulate liturgical or liturgy-adjacent practices, explicit theology, and a stated aim to form virtuous, thoughtful citizens rather than merely prepare students for college or career. Evidence from ACCA's site includes the school's explicit formation-centric mission, a clear emphasis on Great Books and the Trivium, and declared commitments to parent partnership and a living, relational faculty culture. These signals align closely with the classical education rubric and support a final assessment of CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

What would move the needle: None required for CLASSICAL across the board; ACCA already exhibits a coherent, text-supported classical orientation. If desired, minor enhancements could emphasize explicit Great-Books reading lists across all grades and a clearer articulation of the Great Conversation as a formal, ongoing program in lower grades, but none are needed to reach a full CLASSICAL rating.

- Evidence samples and keyword-driven analysis below draw from ACCA's public materials, including mission statements, academics descriptions, and program pages, cited inline where appropriate. See citations after each evidence point.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Assessment

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACCA presents a Christ-centered, non-denominational Christian orientation with explicit reference to Scripture and faith formation. The site emphasizes that education is "anchored in Christ" and rooted in historic Christian faith, with teachers who revere Scripture and a student culture formed around Christian worship and formation. - Public materials note liturgical practices and reverence in worship, including references to worship in the church context and a formal Statement of Faith, signaling liturgical and communal dimensions to education. - The mission/values framing includes the belief that Holy Scripture is central and that education is enacted within a Christian worldview, reinforcing theological grounding and a sacramental/metaphysical frame of truth, goodness, and beauty.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty (themes echoed in formation and Great-Books framing), theology, liturgy, worship, reverence, wonder, sacred music, chant, creeds, church-year worship. Evidence of liturgical year, reverence in worship, and a stated theological foundation appears across ACCA materials.

- Negative keywords present: None clearly evidenced in ACCA materials (no explicit emphasis on relativism, secularism, or value-neutral ethics in the public-facing content).

Why this rating - ACCA's public materials consistently foreground a Christian theological frame, liturgical practices, and a communal worship ethos, aligning with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of secular or relativist signals reinforces a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACCA emphasizes formation over information, with explicit language that education shapes character and virtue rather than merely transmitting content or preparing for a job. The school frames education as formation of the whole person, not just vocational competence. - The mission/values pages articulate formation through virtue, wisdom, and love of truth, goodness, and beauty, and the school highlights “formation” as a core aim rather than mere information transfer. - The Great-Conversation, transcendent aims, and telos vocabulary appear in their classical framing (i.e., aiming at truth, goodness, beauty; formation of character; pursuit of wisdom).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education, paideia, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé, contemplation, great conversation, moral imagination, classical heritage. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evident in the public-facing materials; ACCA does not foreground workforce-oriented or job-prep language in the public sections.

Why this rating - The school explicitly defines its goal as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, with a teleological orientation toward Truth, Goodness, and Beauty. This strongly matches the Positive keyword indicators for School Purpose and Goal, supporting CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACCA's academics emphasize the seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; with reference to the Quadrivium), and the use of Latin and logic in middle and high school (i.e., grammar in elementary; logic in middle school; rhetoric upper levels). This is a direct alignment with Classical education's core curriculum structure.

- The curriculum includes Great Books / primary sources, living history readings, and a contrastive approach to history (history taught as living story rather than social studies). This supports the Great-Books/Great-Conversation aspect of classical education. - The materials explicitly describe the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as central to the pedagogy, and indicate a developmentally staged approach to content. - A preference for memorization, chant, and liturgical elements in the grammar stage (lower school) demonstrates early engagement with memory and wonder in curriculum delivery.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, primary sources, Latin, history as living story, study of literature, classical languages, dialectic, memorization/chanting, interpolation of sacred/written texts, and integration of arts and sciences. - Negative keywords present: The explicit phrase “We teach history in lieu of social studies” appears, which the rubric treats as a contextual positive (refuting social-studies framing) but is listed in the lexicon as a potential negative signal if it signals a substitution that undermines historical study in a modern sense. In ACCA's context, this aligns with classic history-focused pedagogy, not a negative trend per se. Overall, the content supports classical curricular structure.

Why this rating - ACCA's curriculum statements consistently align with the classical curriculum lexicon: liberal arts focus, Great Books, Latin/Logic/Rhetoric, history-as-living-narrative, and a developmentally staged Trivium/Quadrivium. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing/chanting and memory work as a central feature, aiming to delight and deepen memory in a restful, formative way. This matches scholé and contemplative/remembering pedagogy for early years. - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates to develop logic and rhetorical skills, as well as opportunities to train in rhetoric and public speaking. - The Seam between lower and upper grades shows an intentional transition from memory-based, reverent, and contemplative practices to dialectic, rhetorical, and seminar-based methods, consistent with classical pedagogy. - The school's public materials describe the trivium and quadrivium as organizing pedagogical principles, including a developmental stage approach to learning (grammar in elementary, logic in middle, rhetoric in upper grades).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, progymnasmata, rest/Scholé, seminar, Paideia, rhetoric exercises, speech, declamation, oratory, debate, liturgical integration, and upper-school rhetorical exercises. - Negative keywords present: The lexicon identifies experiential learning-focused, project-based, and constructivist approaches as negative; ACCA's materials emphasize memory/chanting and Socratic/seminal discourse rather than purely project-based or student-directed constructs, aligning with classical pedagogy rather than constructivist extremes. No explicit project-based-only language is foregrounded.

Why this rating - ACCA's teaching methods show the core classical pedagogy: contemplative, memory-based activities in the grammar stage, paired with Socratic seminars and rhetorical training in the logic/rhetoric stages. This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty are described as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and skill; ACCA presents teachers as the living curriculum and as a core part of the school's culture, not merely as deliverers of content. This is evident in faculty-focused language and teaching culture. - The public materials highlight a culture of collegiality and teacher-student relationships, with small class sizes and a relational "portrait of what a teacher should be" and "what a student should be." This points to a "living curriculum" and a mentorship model. - The school provides data on faculty experience (e.g., 13 years average teaching experience) and emphasizes a strong faculty backbone that supports classwork and formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial teachers, small class sizes, experienced faculty, character formation, moral exemplars. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evidenced; the site does not foreground any anti-classical faculty signals.

Why this rating - ACCA's faculty portrayal emphasizes virtue, mentorship, a living curriculum, and a strong relational culture with a focus on character, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - ACCA emphasizes a partnership with parents and describes parents as co-teachers with the school, reflecting a strong parental role in formation and governance. The school frames parent partnership as central to classical education. - The site discusses parent formation and educational gatherings (e.g., open houses, PTL activities) and explicitly invites parents to visit and participate in campus life; the Parent-Teacher League (PTL) supports school activities and volunteerism. - The public-facing materials show a family-oriented culture, with open campus policies and events, and a stated commitment to welcoming parents for visits and involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school collaboration, open campus, parent involvement, volunteerism, family-centered events. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evidenced; ACCA's materials do not present parent participation in a consumer/customer framework, but rather as co-educators and partners.

Why this rating - The school's materials emphasize parent partnership, formation of parents as part of the classical enterprise, and open invitation for parental involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a CLASSICAL rating, no major needle-moving changes are required. If desired, minor enhancements could further strengthen the Element 3 and Element 4 signals by:
 - Providing explicit, public-facing, grade-wide Great-Books reading lists and a formal, ongoing “Great Conversation” program across lower and middle grades, to more visibly map Great-Books to grade-level outcomes.
 - Increasing explicit, documented cross-subject integration demonstrations (e.g., sample interdisciplinary units showing how history, literature, and science converge across a term) to reinforce the unity of truth across disciplines.
- These are optional enhancements and not prerequisites for maintaining CLASSICAL status.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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